A-A-53801
13 February 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

KNIFE, MARGIN FINISHING, Dental

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This commercial item description covers a double-ended margin trimming knife.

Salient characteristics:

Material. The operative ends of the knife shall be class 4, Type 440A, 440B or 440C martensitic stainless steel in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard F899. The handle shall be stainless steel or plated brass. Brass shall conform to copper alloy No. C26000, as specified in ASTM B135 for chemical composition only. Brass handles shall be chromium over nickel plated.

Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the Rockwell hardness of the operative ends shall be C52 to C56 for type 440A, C54 to C58 for type 440B, and C56 to C60 for type 440C stainless steel when tested as specified herein.

Style, design and dimensions. The knife shall be a No. 14L, double-ended, margin trimming knife suitable for trimming excess filling material, such as amalgam and composite, from the margins of dental restorations. The knife shall be of three-piece construction, and shall consist of a handle and two operative ends. The handle shall be hollow, and octagonal or round in cross section. The handle shall have a serrated or knurled portion to provide a suitable finger grip, and shall be permanently and legibly marked with the instrument identification. The interface between the operative ends and the handle shall be smoothly blended, with no crevices evident. There shall be no movement, loosening, or separation between the operative end and the handle when the operative end is subjected to an 85 pound (minimum) pull out force, as specified herein. The style, design and dimensions of the knife shall conform to DPSC drawing 24576.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520
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Finish. The operative ends and shanks shall have a smooth mirror or bright finish, except for the surfaces that form the cutting edges, which shall have a finely honed finish. The operative end cutting edges shall be sharp and shall be free of defects such as rough grind marks, cracks, gouges, burrs, feathers, and other imperfections when viewed under four power (4X) magnification. Handles shall have a mirror or bright finish, except for the serrated or knurled finger grip portions. Finger grip portions of handles shall provide adequate finger grip during use.

Corrosion resistance. The copper sulfate test shall apply to the operative ends. The boil test shall apply to the entire knife.

Identification marking. All marking shall be on the smooth portion of the handle and shall be permanent and legible. Each knife shall be marked with knife identification "14L". Each knife shall be marked with the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer (and contractor, if other than the manufacturer) and the word "stainless", when applicable. As an alternate to the word "stainless", the use of a registered trade name identifying the steel as stainless shall be acceptable, provided prior approval is received from the cognizant contracting officer. Instruments of foreign (other than U.S.) manufacture shall also be marked with the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. The knife shall be free from defects which may detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One knife, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or materials, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II, except that inspection level shall be S-1 for dimensions.

Examination. The knives shall be examined to determine compliance with the specification requirements. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to, the defects listed below.

Defects.

Style and design not as specified.
Finish of operative end and shank not as specified.
Operative end not free from coarse grind marks, cracks, burrs, deep pits, feathers, and other imperfections.
Dimensions of operative ends not as specified on drawing.
Finish of handle not as specified.
Finish of handle not free of coarse grind marks.
Knives not free from dirt, oil, polishing compound, and foreign matter.
Identification marking not present, not properly located, illegible, or incomplete.
Dimensions of handle not as specified on drawing.
Handle serrations or knurl missing, not uniform, or not complete.
Handle serration or knurl dimensions not as specified.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified below, except that the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one knife.

Test criteria.

Component	Characteristic	Inspection Level
Entire instrument	Composition	**
Operative ends	Hardness	S-2
Operative ends	Copper sulfate	S-2
Entire instrument	Boil test	S-2
Entire instrument	Pull test	S-2

** A sufficient amount from each lot of metal used in the construction of the knives shall be selected for composition analysis.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with the requirements of this specification. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Chemical analysis. In the absence of certificates of quality for the raw material, chemical analysis of the instruments shall be conducted in accordance with method 111 or 112 of FED-STD-151. In the event of a conflict, method 111 shall govern.

Hardness. Hardness of the operative ends shall be tested in accordance with ASTM E-18 (Rockwell) or E-92 (Vickers or Diamond pyramid). Conversion of Vickers hardness values to Rockwell hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM E-140.

Corrosion resistance. Knives shall be tested for resistance to corrosion in accordance with the boil test and copper sulfate test of ASTM F1089.

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Pull test. The handle and shank of the operative end shall be securely held in separate chucks or other holding devices. A slowly increasing pull out force, increasing from zero to 85 pounds (minimum), shall be applied to the shank of the operative end. The force shall be maintained at the high value for a minimum of one second. The instrument shall be examined for movement, looseness, or separation of the operative end from the handle. The test shall be repeated for each operative end of the double-ended instrument.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pounds units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerance specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable . The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereafter. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers with requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document.

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-01-261-5964	KNIFE, MARGIN FINISHING, DENTAL, No. 14L, Double-ended.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PROJECT NO. 6520-2068
LOCATION - NCR DISK 5

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53801	KNIFE, ..ARGIN FINISHING, Dental

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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